

Say cheese!

Japanese designer Motoi and Daito introduce the LED smile that makes your teeth flash in different colors. What'll they come up with next?

Sony expands Qriocity

In the face of tough competition from the likes of Grooveshark and Last.fm, Sony is gung-ho about its music streaming service

Error Code 43, SMPS fan not working, Disabling ctfmon

Digit Q&A answers these queries and more...

Upgrading to a 64-bit OS

I use Windows 7 32-bit OS, and I want to upgrade to 64-bit without any data loss. I need to do this because I want to install Adobe After Effects CS5. My system configuration is as follows:

Processor: Intel Core 2 Duo E8300

Motherboard: G41MT-ES2L

GPU: Radeon HD 5770

RAM: 2 GB DDR3

OS: Microsoft Windows 7 Ultimate Edition.

Shubhankar Sahu

You can upgrade from the Windows 7 32-bit OS to 64-bit OS by doing a clean install. You will need a 64-bit copy of the Windows 7 Ultimate Edition which comes with its own set of 64-bit drivers (they are not compatible with 32-bit drivers). You will need to backup all your data onto an external drive before the clean install. It would also help if you could add 2GB DDR3 RAM to the existing configuration.

Dual booting issues

I have a Compaq laptop with the following configuration:

Processor: Intel Core 2 Duo (2.2 GHz)

RAM: 3 GB

Hard disk: 360 GB.

I want to use Linux and Windows simultaneously.

Shafique Azmat

You will need to dual-boot your system to have both Windows and Linux running on the same machine. Dual booting is not all that difficult as people think. To dual boot, you need to create two partitions in your hard disk. Get all your data backed up before you plan to partition your hard drive. First install Windows in your C drive, and then install Linux on the other partition. While installing the distro of your choice, keep in mind the size of the partition you want to install Linux into. The installation process of some distros such as PCLinuxOS is particularly friendly for dual booting. The Linux boot loader will allow you to choose Windows or Linux during startup. If you simply want to try out different distros, you needn't even install them. You can use VirtualBox to run Linux on a software layer.



SMPS fan not working

The SMPS fan on my computer does not work, but my computer works absolutely fine. I have seen many computers where the fan does not rotate and some which work. How can I switch on the fan?

Praik Ranjan Bhuyan

SMPS fan may not work for either of the three reasons:

- 1) The SMPS is out of order and you need to replace it.
- 2) Cable providing power to the fan is cut somewhere.
- 3) The fan has jammed due to accumulation of dust or lack of lubrication.

As you say your system is working fine, it seems like either of the last two cases. You will have to take it to a service centre to get the fan cleaned. If your computer also does not start, then you will have to replace the SMPS.

Pictures vertically squeezing

I have a Samsung Syncmaster B 2030 LCD Monitor. All the pictures from my digital camera appear squeezed vertically on screen. How can I adjust it so that I can get actual view? I am using Windows 7 on AMD



Boot selection screen